

I tried recording sound with Sound Recorder. It cuts off after 60 seconds. What's the best way to create songs on my PC?

Sound Recorder is a rather crude program. If you keep hitting the Record button every 60 seconds, Sound Recorder will keep appending the audio and you will be able to record more than just one minute. A better way to record sound is to use a free utility such as Direct to

(www.mgshareware.com) to convert it to an MP3. Software such as VOB2Audio (www.digital-digest.com/dvd/downloads/vob2audio.html) can save sound clips from DVD files. A convenient way to rip audio, irrespective of the source, is to use software such as MP3 Studio (www.nicolasoft.com). This records any sound passing through your soundcard, so if the movie is playing, the sound can be grabbed to an MP3 file.



How do I create and print inlay cards and song lists for my CDs?

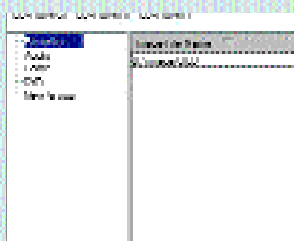
Today, many CD writing applications are bundled with an inlay card printer that lets you make jewel case covers. You can also make your own, using Microsoft Word. All you need to do is place text boxes of the correct size, enter your list and other details into it, and print. For a song list on the back of the jewel case, you can place three text boxes next to each other. The first and last ones can be of 11.8 cm height and 0.6 cm width, with the text direction (*Format > Text Direction*) set to vertical. These will appear on the spine of the jewel case. Between these, you would have an 11.8x13.8 cm text box. This goes behind your jewel case for the song list. Similarly, to design an inlay for the front of the jewel case, use a text box of size 11.96x12.6 cm. Print all of these out and cut them along the borders. If you find Word too cumbersome or limiting, there are

hundreds of other tools such as CDCoverPrint (www.alienaus.com/software/cdcp0.shtml), which you can use to print jewel case inlays.

I have such a large hard disk, but games don't run if I copy the CD on to it. How do I avoid having to put in the CD every time?

Many games, encyclopaedias and other similar CDs require the CD to be in the drive for them to work. This is either because the software

inal CD Emulator (www.ztekkware.com), which can emulate CD-ROM drives for data as well as audio CDs. All you need to do is install the software and configure which folder on your hard disk you want it to emulate as a CD. Thus, you can copy entire CDs to your hard disk in separate folders and have them all appear as different CD-ROM drives. This software effectively fools the application into thinking there is an actual CD-ROM drive with the application CD in it. Another advantage with this is that of speed—being on the hard disk, the program will run much faster than if the program disk were actually in the CD drive.

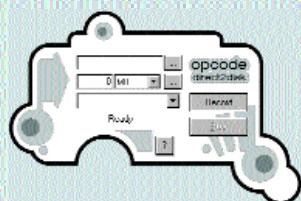


Emulate CD-ROM drives from your hard disk

needs to access resources from the CD or it is a measure taken to prevent piracy. There are several tools available, such as the Virtual Orig-

I need to send this file to my friend, but there's no point burning a CD for such a small file and it won't fit on a floppy.

To share large files, you can split them into smaller chunks and use a set of floppies or the Internet to transfer



Direct to Disk audio recorder

Disk Audio Recorder (<http://www.opcode.co.uk/opd2d/default.asp>). With almost all such sound recording software, you can capture as much audio as your hard disk can hold.

Can I extract a song as an MP3 from a movie?

To extract sound clips from a movie, you will need a video editing software. For VCDs, a software such as VCD Cutter (www.sellerclub.com/~vcdcut/) or VirtualDub (www.virtualdub.org) will work just fine. In either software, cut out the length of the movie that you want the audio clip from, then save the audio from it. If saved as a WAV file, you can use a free utility called FreeRIP MP3



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